

David Horn

CTO | VP Engineering | Applied AI Executive

Seattle, WA

<https://horn.gg>

david@horn.gg

858.775.3298

- **AI and product engineering executive with 22 years of full stack experience building zero-to-one products** delivering category-defining platforms in fintech, streaming media, and esports, including DisneyLife (precursor to Disney+), Twitch Creator Dashboard, and the Brex AI automation suite.
- **Scale and P&L leadership:** built engineering organizations from 3 to 50+ people across multiple cities and countries, guided \$1M-\$10M cloud and ML budgets, and steered roadmaps that balance innovation with compliance and reliability.
- **Applied AI business impact:** grew automated receipt acquisition at Brex from 0 to 40 percent of expenses, lifted receipt-matching accuracy from 65 to 80 percent, and launched AI-powered spend management platform that drove compliance rate of customers to 94+%.
- **Thought leader and inventor:** two granted US patents in content curation and AI-driven narrative tone conversion, and regular conference speaker with a career-long focus on data-driven decision making.

Leadership Experience

Brex

Head of AI

Jun 2022 - present

- **Scope:** Leading 20-person AI/ML org; owned ~\$5M cloud/ML budget; platform supporting AI product features and \$10B+ risk models; DRI for org-wide AI enablement.
- **Product:** Grew AI memos to ~30% of expenses, scaled auto-receipts from 0 to 40% and improved matching 65 to 80%. This cut manual data entry by 300+ hours/month (avg mid-size org).
- **Operations:** Launched AI CX platform with over 50% containment and refactored back-office workflows delivering ~10× cost reduction.
- **AI Engineering:** Drove AI tool adoption and training across all functions; updated engineering interview loops to include AI coding challenges; led AI-driven codebase rewrite project, migrating from Kotlin to TypeScript, increasing AI codegen rate to over 80%.

Trophy Interactive

Cofounder and CEO
Apr 2020 - Jul 2021

- Cofounded esports social platform as CEO, head of product, and full-stack engineer, building a cross-platform desktop app with real-time gameplay capture and analysis
- Developed scalable web platform on Firebase with Django REST API, supporting gameplay clip sharing and social features
- Achieved product-market validation with 50+ engaged daily active users before wind-down due to funding constraints

Amazon Twitch

Senior Manager,
Engineering
Feb 2019 - Apr 2020

- Managed engineering, technical product, and project execution for Creator Business vertical serving Twitch's top revenue generators, managing 13 critical live services supporting millions of Twitch streamers globally with 99.9%+ uptime
- Delivered Twitch Creator Dashboard from concept to TwitchCon keynote launch in 8 months, becoming primary creator management platform

Disney DCPI

Director, Engineering
Aug 2010 - Jan 2019

- Built engineering organization from 3 to 46 engineers across 4 cities with median retention of five years; established Disney's streaming media and mobile app capabilities; expanded consumer products and interactive media app portfolio to over 10 apps
- Led engineering for launch of Disney's first cloud streaming service, DisneyLife (precursor to Disney+), in test markets, serving millions across UK, France, Italy, Ireland, and Philippines with multi-platform SVOD experience. Executed as Disney's first cloud service.

Patents

Content Promotion Through Automated Curation of Content Clips - US Patent [10911803](#) (Apr 16, 2020)

Automated Conversion of Vocabulary and Narrative Tone - US Patent [10810382](#) (Oct 20, 2020)

Education

California Polytechnic State University, San Luis Obispo - B.S. in Statistics (2010) - Thesis: PageRank approximation with imperfect graph knowledge

Technical Experience

Cloud & Data: AWS, GCP, Snowflake, Databricks, DynamoDB, Spanner, PostgreSQL

AI/ML: OpenAI, Anthropic, Llama, SageMaker, LangChain, Vector DBs, Braintrust

Backend: Python, Go, Kotlin, Django, FastAPI, NestJS, Typescript

Frontend & Desktop: React / Next.js, React Native, Electron, TypeScript

DevOps & Observability: Terraform, Hex, Datadog, Retool, Jenkins, Docker, Kubernetes